

INTRO SCRIPT

Welcome to **The Improving Edge**. This is where we talk about how AI and technology actually show up in real organizations; what works, what doesn't, and what we're learning along the way. I'll be sharing conversations with people doing the work, turning innovation into outcomes.

Season 1, Episode 8

AI-Ready Data: The New Benchmark of Enterprise Competitiveness

Episode Overview

We'll dig into why data readiness — not the model you pick — is the real competitive moat in the AI era. Most enterprises think they're further along than they are, and the gap between perception and reality is where AI investments go to die. Nick brings two decades of enterprise engineering experience to the question every leader needs to answer before they spend another dollar on AI tooling.

Key Discussion Topics

#	TOPIC	FOCUS
1	What AI-Ready Data Means	Moving past the buzzword — what it actually takes for data to be ready for AI, not just reporting.
2	The Self-Assessment Gap	Why most enterprises overestimate their data readiness, and what the real gap looks like from the inside.
3	Data vs. Models	Why the model you pick matters less than the data underneath it — and how that's shifted the competitive advantage.
4	Agentic AI Raises the Stakes	How agentic systems change the requirements: data isn't just being analyzed anymore, it's being acted on.
5	What Good Actually Looks Like	The markers of AI-ready data — metadata, lineage, governance, ownership — and what companies get wrong.

Prompting Questions

1. On Defining AI-Ready Data

"AI-ready data is almost a buzzword at this point. Take it beyond the buzzword — what does it actually mean for an enterprise to have data that's ready for AI?"

2. On the Self-Assessment Problem

"Do most enterprises think they're further along than they actually are? What's the typical gap between how ready they think they are and what you find when you actually look?"

3. On Agentic AI

"Give us a quick grounding in agentic AI, and then explain how it changes the requirements. Because these systems aren't just analyzing data — they're acting on it. What happens when they act on bad data?"

4. On Layering AI on Legacy

"A lot of organizations are stacking AI solutions on top of legacy data infrastructure. What actually happens when you do that? And what's the risk of treating it as a permanent fix rather than a bridge?"

5. On What Good Looks Like

"Walk me through the markers of truly AI-ready data — metadata, lineage, governance, ownership. What do companies most commonly overlook? And how do you know when you're actually there?"

6. Wrap-Up

"What are a couple of takeaways you'd like the listeners to walk away with?"

REMEMBER: Keep it conversational (60% guest / 40% host) • Share personal stories • Have fun!

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